

Bring This To Your Doctor, The Midnight Drift

You have started restoring the overnight dip in your blood pressure by rebuilding your sleep. This page helps you have a better conversation at your next visit. Bring it with you. It is a way to share what you are doing and to ask good questions, so you and your doctor read your numbers together. It is not instructions for your doctor, and nothing here is a reason to change a medication on your own.

THE READINGS I AM BRINGING

Write in a few of your recent home readings (date, time, and the number).

THE LIFESTYLE CHANGES I HAVE STARTED

- Cut caffeine completely (swapped to chamomile or hibiscus tea)
- Protected my evenings: screens off by 9 PM, no late news or alcohol, a cool dark room
- A fixed wake time every day, including weekends
- A 20-minute morning walk in daylight
- Last meal finished 2 to 3 hours before bed, with a light, plant-based supper
- Long-exhale breathing at lights-out, plus a daily sleep log kept alongside my blood pressure readings

Herbs and supplements I have added: Magnesium glycinate, tart cherry, and any of chamomile, passionflower, or lemon balm I have added, one at a time.

QUESTIONS TO ASK ABOUT MY NUMBERS

Looking at the readings I brought, how do my numbers look to you?

I have been logging my sleep next to my readings. Would you review the two together with me?

I was waking around 2 to 3 AM most nights when I started. Is that pattern something you would want to look into further?

What range would you like me to aim for, given my history, and how often would you like me to check at home?

Are there any readings that should prompt me to call you?

QUESTIONS TO ASK ABOUT MY CURRENT MEDICATION

As my sleep and my numbers change, is there anything you would like to watch in my current medication?

Are any of the herbs or supplements I listed a concern alongside what you have me on?

Does the timing of any of my medications matter for my overnight blood pressure, and is my current timing right for me?

If my readings keep improving, what would you want to see before we discuss any medication change, and how would you want to approach it?

Is there any sign or symptom I should report to you between visits?

This sheet is yours, to help you partner with your doctor. It is educational, not medical advice, and not a set of instructions for your physician. Every decision about your medication and treatment belongs to you and your doctor together. Never start, stop, or change a prescription on your own. © BraveWorks RN . Joel Polley, RN . bpquiz.com.